

Saturday, 8 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 28° 18°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 27° 13°	MANCHESTER Overcast 26° 13°	GLASGOW Heavy drizzle 19° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A serial sex offender, who was being monitored by police, has been found guilty of double murder and rape.

Simon Levy was under Metropolitan Police surveillance when he committed the horrific crimes. The verdict brings a degree of closure to the victims' families.

CRIME · UK
- 2

The officer who led the investigation into PC Andrew Harper's death says he's 'appalled' that the killers could be released early.

Former Detective Superintendent Stuart Blaik has spoken out publicly for the first time about the case. His comments highlight ongoing concerns about sentencing and parole for serious crimes.

POLICING · UK
- 3

Two brothers have been jailed after killing a man and injuring his son while racing cars on a public road.

Abubakr and Umar Ben Yusaf were racing near Welshpool in November 2024 when the fatal incident occurred. The court heard the pair were driving dangerously.

CRIME · UK
- 4

Police have made further arrests in Thetford as disorder continues, linked to anti-immigration protests in the market town.

The arrests follow a series of disturbances that have raised concerns in the community. Authorities are working to restore calm and maintain public safety.

PUBLIC ORDER · UK
- 5

The Conservative Party has pledged to ban foreign nationals from social housing, claiming it would free up thousands of homes.

They suggest around 230,000 homes could become available under their proposed plan. This is a significant policy announcement ahead of the next election.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Could new music be on the way from The Fugees? Lauryn Hill says she and Wyclef are 'in an amazing place'.**

Fans are hoping for a new album from the iconic group, 30 years after their last. Hill mentioned an 'incredible healing process' between the band members.

ON AIR – Would you be excited for a new Fugees album after all this time? Or should some bands leave their legacy untouched?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 2 Good news for soap fans and Strictly viewers – Emmerdale actor Lawrence Robb is joining the Strictly Come Dancing line-up!**

Lawrence, who plays Mackenzie 'Mack' Boyd in the ITV soap, will be swapping the Dales for the dancefloor. It'll be exciting to see how he takes to the sequins and salsa.

ON AIR – Who are you most excited to see on Strictly this year? And how do you think Lawrence will do?

TV · COMING UP
- 3 Rihanna fans, get ready! Her partner A\$AP Rocky has confirmed the superstar is back 'in the studio' and 'cooking' up new music.**

It's been a long wait since her last full album in 2016, so this is huge news. We're all eagerly anticipating what she'll bring out next.

ON AIR – What kind of sound are you hoping for from Rihanna's new music? Do you think she'll stick to her roots or try something new?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 4 A brand new exhibition celebrating the legendary Sir Billy Connolly is coming to Glasgow next year!**

Billy Connolly's Big Wee Exhibition will open at the Kelvingrove Art Gallery from next June. It promises to be a fantastic tribute to the much-loved comedian.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Billy Connolly memory or routine? He's truly a national treasure!

EXHIBITION · COMING UP
- 5 The promoter behind Oasis's legendary Knebworth gigs has been granted a licence for future events at the park.**

This news has sparked fresh rumours about a potential return to the iconic venue. Could we see another huge concert series there soon?

ON AIR – If you could see any band play Knebworth, who would it be? And do you think Oasis will ever reunite?

MUSIC · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1 Manchester City have rejected a £38 million bid from Barcelona for their star midfielder Rodri.**
 City are also currently in talks with Lille for midfielder Ayyoub Bouaddi. It seems like a busy transfer window for the Premier League champions.
ON AIR – Rodri is such a key player for City, how important is it that they hold onto him? And who would you like to see them sign?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Newcastle United's sporting director has revealed that 'very emotional' captain Bruno Guimaraes wanted to leave the club for Arsenal.**
 Ross Wilson said the club didn't plan to sell him, but Guimaraes clearly had his heart set on a move. It's a big talking point for Newcastle fans.
ON AIR – How do you feel about players who are open about wanting to leave, even if they're club captains? Does it affect your view of them?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 The Football Association has banned solid perimeter walls around pitches after a safety review following a player's death.**
 The decision comes after the tragic death of former Arsenal youth player Billy Vigar. It's a crucial step to improve safety standards in football.
ON AIR – Player safety is paramount, isn't it? What other changes do you think are needed to make football safer at all levels?
 FOOTBALL · UK
- 4 Cameron Norrie produced a superb fightback at the Canadian Open, saving a match point to beat world number seven Alex de Minaur.**
 It was a fantastic display of resilience from the British tennis star. He's showing great form on the hard courts.
ON AIR – What a performance from Norrie! Do you think he has what it takes to go deep into the tournament this year?
 TENNIS · UK
- 5 Atletico Madrid are reportedly in talks to sign Tottenham captain Cristian Romero this summer.**
 Romero is expected to leave Spurs, and a move to the Spanish giants could be on the cards. It would be a significant departure for Tottenham.
ON AIR – If Romero leaves, who do you think Tottenham should bring in to replace him? And how big a loss would he be?
 FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people embracing 'slow TV' for relaxation.**
Programmes featuring long, uninterrupted shots of mundane activities, like a train journey or knitting, are gaining popularity for their calming effect.
- 2 The simple art of 'doodling during meetings' is being hailed as a creativity booster.**
Studies suggest that light sketching while listening can actually improve focus and aid memory retention, rather than being a distraction.
- 3 Experts are suggesting that 'adopting a houseplant' can significantly improve indoor air quality and mood.**
Even just one leafy companion can make a difference to your home environment, bringing a touch of nature indoors.
- 4 The unexpected joy of 'revisiting childhood board games' is bringing families together.**
Many are rediscovering the fun and nostalgia of classic games, opting for screen-free entertainment on family nights.
- 5 A study reveals the 'comforting power of wearing mismatched socks' for self-expression.**
Participants reported feeling a subtle sense of rebellious joy and individuality when sporting non-matching hosiery.
- 6 There's a growing appreciation for the 'sound of rain on a windowpane' as a natural sleep aid.**
Many are now actively seeking out recordings or simply opening a window to enjoy the soothing rhythms of a rainy evening for better rest.
- 7 The humble 'garden shed' is undergoing a stylish transformation into a multi-functional space.**
From art studios to quiet reading rooms, sheds are becoming extensions of the home rather than just storage units.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our socks after they come out of the washing machine, even if we know it's a bit of a gamble?

ANSWER: TRYING TO GUESS WHICH ONES BELONG TO WHOM, WITHOUT LOOKING AT THE PAIRS!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh cup of tea. What is it?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE TEABAG OR LOOSE LEAF TEA FIRST, EVERY SINGLE TIME!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you discover a 'shortcut' that completely changes your daily routine for the better, even if it's just a tiny one?

We're talking about those clever little detours, time-savers, or alternative routes that you stumbled upon, and now you can't imagine life without them. What's your favourite 'secret shortcut'?

- Think about a 'small act of kindness' from a stranger that really brightened your day and has stayed with you.

Whether it was someone holding a door, letting you go ahead in a queue, or just offering a kind word, we'd love to hear about those lovely moments when someone unexpectedly made your day a little bit better.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Before pencils, Romans wrote with a stylus on a thin sheet of lead, which left a faint, erasable mark.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The very first 'tea bags' were accidentally invented when a tea merchant sent samples in silk pouches, which customers then tried to brew whole.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest mammal is the bumblebee bat, found in Thailand and Myanmar.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The inventor of the Pringles can was buried in one.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The iconic red telephone box was designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott, who also designed Liverpool Cathedral.
- Penguins are the only birds that can swim but not fly.
- The 'smiley face' emoticon was created in 1982 by computer scientist Scott Fahlman.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the known universe.

On this day

Day 220 of the year, 145 days left in 2026. Today Ceasefire Day (end of Iran–Iraq War) (Iraqi Kurdistan); Christian Feast Day: Altmann of Passau; Christian Feast Day: Bonifacia Rodríguez y Castro; Christian Feast Day: Cyriacus and companions. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Larry Wilcox, American actor, director, and producer
- 1962 — Kool Moe Dee, American musician, singer and actor
- 1949 — Terry Burnham, American actress (died 2013)
- 1951 — Martin Brest, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1973 — Mark Wills, American singer-songwriter
- 1980 — Michael Urie, American actor, director, and producer
- 1964 — Paul Taylor, English cricketer
- 1989 — Ken Baumann, American actor and author

THE DAY TODAY

- 2007 — Space Shuttle program: STS-118 Mission: Endeavour takes off on a mission to the International Space Station.
- 2022 — The Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) executes a search warrant at former president Donald Trump's residence in Mar-a-Lago, Palm Beach, Florida.
- 2001 — Albanian rebels ambush a convoy of the Army of the Republic of Macedonia near Tetovo, killing 10 soldiers.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2004 — A tour bus belonging to the Dave Matthews Band dumps approximately 800 pounds of human waste onto a boat full of passengers.
- 2019 — An explosion at the State Central Navy Testing Range in Nyonoksa, Russia, kills five people.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1973 — Kim Dae-jung, a South Korean politician and later president of South Korea, is kidnapped.
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2008 — A EuroCity express train en route from Kraków, Poland to Prague, Czech Republic strikes a part of a motorway bridge that had fallen onto the railroad track near Studénka railway station in the Czech Republic and derailed, killing eight people and injuring 64 others.

- 2010 — China Floods: A mudslide in Zhugqu County, Gansu, China, kills more than 1,400 people.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 221 of the year, 144 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Gangut Day (Russia); Christian feast day: Candida Maria of Jesus; Christian feast day: Edith Stein (St Teresa Benedicta of the Cross); Christian feast day: Firmus and Rusticus. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — Paul Gallagher, Scottish footballer
- 1958 — Amanda Bearse, American actress, comedian and director
- 1947 — Barbara Mason, American R&B/soul singer-songwriter
- 1970 — Thomas Lennon, American actor and comedian
- 1972 — Ryan Bollman, American actor
- 1959 — Kurtis Blow, American rapper, producer, and actor
- 1939 — Butch Warren, American bassist (died 2013)
- 1991 — Alice Barlow, English actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1995 — Aviateca Flight 901 crashes into the San Vicente volcano in El Salvador, killing all 65 people on board.
- 1944 — The United States Forest Service and the Wartime Advertising Council release posters featuring Smokey Bear for the first time.
- 1960 — South Kasai secedes from the Congo.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1944 — World War II: Continuation War: The Vyborg–Petrozavodsk Offensive, the largest offensive launched by Soviet Union against Finland during the Second World War, ends to a strategic stalemate. Both Finnish and Soviet troops at the Finnish front dug to defensive positions, and the...
- 2021 — The Tampere light rail officially starts operating.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)